

STEP 3 OF 9

Don't Build When You Build-Measure-Learn

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Entrepreneurs and intrapreneurs often start building early versions of their products and services way too soon. They don't realize that the search phase of building a new product or business is optimized for learning. The goal early on is to create the most learning as quickly and efficiently as possible.

The Build-Measure-Learn feedback loop is at the heart of the Lean Startup process. In the "build" stage, you create early stage prototypes and minimum viable products (MVPs). An MVP is an artifact or representation of a value proposition. It is designed to test the validity of one or more critical assumptions, or so-called hypotheses, surrounding a business model or value proposition.

Unfortunately, entrepreneurs and intrapreneurs often mistake prototypes and MVPs as limited versions of the future products or services they want to build. But the term "build" in the Lean Startup feedback loop should not always be taken so literally.

In other words, the goal is not to start building a limited version of your product or service. The goal is to achieve maximum learning for the least amount of effort.

Learn more about building MVPs in the next video.